

General marking guidance

These notes offer general guidance, but the specific notes for examiners appertaining to individual questions take precedence.

1 All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the last candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the first.

Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded; exemplification/indicative content will not be exhaustive. When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the response should be sent to review.

2 All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded; mark schemes should be applied positively. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme. If there is a wrong answer (or no answer) indicated on the answer line always check the working in the body of the script (and on any diagrams), and award any marks appropriate from the mark scheme.

Questions where working is not required: In general, the correct answer should be given full marks.
Questions that specifically require working: In general, candidates who do not show working on this type of question will get no marks – full details will be given in the mark scheme for each individual question.

3 **Crossed out work**
This should be marked **unless** the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

4 **Choice of method**
If there is a choice of methods shown, mark the method that leads to the answer given on the answer line.

If no answer appears on the answer line, mark both methods **then award the lower number of marks.**

5 **Incorrect method**
If it is clear from the working that the “correct” answer has been obtained from incorrect working, award 0 marks. Send the response to review for your Team Leader to check.

6 **Follow through marks**
Follow through marks which involve a single stage calculation can be awarded without working as you can check the answer, but if ambiguous do not award.
Follow through marks which involve more than one stage of calculation can only be awarded on sight of the relevant working, even if it appears obvious that there is only one way you could get the answer given.

Ignoring subsequent work

It is appropriate to ignore subsequent work when the additional work does not change the answer in a way that is inappropriate for the question or its context. (eg. an incorrectly cancelled fraction when the unsimplified fraction would gain full marks).

It is not appropriate to ignore subsequent work when the additional work essentially makes the answer incorrect (eg. incorrect algebraic simplification).

M method mark awarded for a correct method or partial method

A accuracy mark (awarded after a correct method or process; if no method or process is seen then full marks for the question are implied but see individual mark schemes for more details)

oe or equivalent

12	(a)	$\frac{4x-6}{3x-9}$	M1	factorises numerator of $4x^2 - 9$ eg $(2x - 3)(2x + 3)$ oe	$\frac{2x(2x-3)(2x+3)}{3x(2x+3)(x-3)}$ Accept $a = 4, b = -6, c = 3, d = -9$
			M1	factorises denominator eg $x(x-3)$ or $3(2x + 3)$ or for $3x(2x^2 - 3x - 9)$	
			A1	cancels to give $\frac{4x-6}{3x-9}$	
	(b)	$\frac{-x+8}{x(x+1)(x-2)}$	M1	method to use a common denominator eg $x(x+1)(x-2)$ by multiplying terms	Method must involve finding equivalents for all three separate terms; may be done in several stages. Equivalents must be algebraically equivalent and must have involved full simplification.
			M1	deduce numerator eg $3x(x-2) + x(x+1) - 4(x+1)(x-2)$	
			A1	oe	